

# Anonymous-PII: A Multilingual Framework for Personally Identifiable Information Extraction in Clinical De-identification

Anonymous ACL submission

## Abstract

Clinical de-identification depends on accurately identifying personally identifiable information (PII). However, manually annotated datasets are costly to build, and existing synthetic alternatives often provide limited generation details or use relatively simple synthesis strategies. We introduce Anonymous-PII-Dataset, which contains one million synthetic clinical documents across seventeen languages and nine PII labels. Attribute-conditioned prompts generate the documents, and thirteen deterministic gates check their structural and annotation validity. To assess the dataset’s utility, we train Anonymous-PII-Model, a BIOES token classifier. We compare it with existing PII extraction systems using exact-match entity-level F1. Anonymous-PII-Model achieves the highest score among the evaluated systems on all reported benchmarks, with a mean F1 of 0.827 across fifteen external benchmarks compared with 0.658 for the strongest baseline. Upon acceptance, we will publicly release the dataset, benchmark, model, generation framework, and evaluation code to support research on multilingual clinical de-identification.

**Keywords:** Natural Language Processing; Named Entity Recognition; Personally Identifiable Information; Synthetic Data; Healthcare

## 1 Introduction

Named Entity Recognition (NER) is a fundamental task in natural language processing. In privacy-sensitive domains such as healthcare, however, the primary objective is identifying personally identifiable information (PII), a specialized subset of named entities whose disclosure may compromise patient privacy (Savkin et al., 2025). Although PII extraction is commonly formulated as an NER task, it differs from general-purpose NER in both

its ontology and application objectives. Consequently, data-driven PII systems require dedicated datasets rather than relying solely on conventional NER corpora. Existing PII datasets are predominantly manually annotated, making them expensive to construct and limiting their scale, language coverage, and domain diversity (Neamatullah et al., 2008; Uzuner et al., 2007; Stubbs et al., 2015). Although several synthetic PII datasets have recently been proposed, most either do not disclose their generation pipeline or rely on relatively simple prompting strategies (Ai4Privacy, 2026; AI, 2024; Steier et al., 2025).

We propose a multilingual synthetic data generation framework that combines attribute-conditioned prompting with deterministic validation to construct Anonymous-PII-Dataset. The framework controls language, document type, text format, scenario, ontology constraints, and challenging edge cases to generate diverse and structurally complex documents. Generated samples that violate the declared requirements are repaired or rejected before inclusion in the dataset. We further train a token-classification model to evaluate the utility of the resulting data. We evaluate the model on fifteen external benchmarks and the Anonymous-PII Benchmark. Our benchmark combines standard and challenging examples under the Anonymous-PII ontology to assess performance across different levels of difficulty.

This paper makes three contributions:

1. We introduce **Anonymous-PII-Dataset**, a synthetic clinical PII dataset containing one million documents across seventeen languages and annotated with a nine-label PII ontology.
2. We present a controlled multilingual synthesis framework that combines multiple document and generation attributes with deterministic structural and annotation validation.

3. We introduce **Anonymous-PII-Model**, a BIOES token classifier, and show that it achieves the highest performance on all evaluated external benchmarks and our benchmark.

## 2 Related Works

### 2.1 PII Datasets

**Manually annotated datasets** Manually annotated PII datasets support supervised training and evaluation, but expert annotation makes them costly to construct and difficult to scale (Deleger et al., 2014). Early clinical de-identification resources focused primarily on English medical records and supported influential shared tasks and system evaluations (Neamatullah et al., 2008; Uzuner et al., 2007; Stubbs et al., 2015). Non-English clinical resources include corpora for French clinical notes and the German GRASCO corpus (Grouin and Névél, 2014; Modersohn et al., 2022). Sensitive-entity datasets have also been developed for Spanish legal text, showing progress beyond the clinical domain (de Gibert et al., 2022). More recent multilingual resources broaden this coverage, but manually annotated datasets still span relatively few languages and domains (Baroud et al., 2026).

**Synthetic datasets** Synthetic generation provides a scalable alternative to manually annotated datasets, and several large PII datasets have recently been released (Ai4Privacy, 2026; AI, 2024; Steier et al., 2025). However, their generation procedures are not always described in enough detail to reproduce the controls used for document diversity, label coverage, and difficult examples. SPY (Savkin et al., 2025) documents its workflow more clearly, including iterative placeholder insertion, synthetic entity swapping, and the addition of unrelated entities. Anonymous-PII-Dataset addresses this reproducibility gap through an independently designed multilingual pipeline that explicitly controls document and generation attributes and applies deterministic validation before accepting samples.

### 2.2 PII Models

**NER Techniques** NER systems identify text spans and assign each span an entity label. Many neural approaches formulate this task as sequence labeling, predicting a label for each token and optionally using a Conditional Random Field (CRF)

to model dependencies between adjacent labels (Souza et al., 2019). Transformer encoders such as BERT improve these predictions by representing each token in its surrounding context (Devlin et al., 2019). Span-based methods instead score candidate spans directly, allowing the model to predict entity boundaries and labels together (Eberts and Ulges, 2019). More recent generalist models, including GLiNER and GLiNER2, use schema-driven interfaces to recognize entity types beyond a single fixed taxonomy (Zaratiana et al., 2023, 2025).

**PII Techniques** PII extraction specializes NER by mapping detected spans to privacy-related labels used for de-identification. Generalist systems such as GLiNER2 can treat these labels as a requested extraction schema, while dedicated systems such as OpenMed-PII and OpenAI Privacy Filter are designed specifically for PII detection (Zaratiana et al., 2025; Science, 2026; OpenAI, 2026). OpenAI Privacy Filter uses bidirectional token classification and span decoding over a fixed taxonomy of privacy labels (OpenAI, 2026). This formulation combines contextual token representations with explicit entity-boundary prediction. Following this approach, we train Anonymous-PII-Model on Anonymous-PII-Dataset using BIOES tagging and our nine-label PII ontology.

## 3 Anonymous-PII-Dataset

### 3.1 Overview

Manually annotated PII datasets provide expert-reviewed labels for training and evaluation, but their cost limits their scale, language coverage, and domain diversity (Deleger et al., 2014; Neamatullah et al., 2008). Synthetic generation offers greater scalability, although insufficiently documented controls and validation procedures can make existing datasets difficult to reproduce (Ai4Privacy, 2026; AI, 2024; Steier et al., 2025). Anonymous-PII-Dataset addresses this trade-off through a multilingual generation framework that makes its generation attributes and deterministic validation process explicit. Figure 1 provides an overview of the complete pipeline.

**Dataset composition** Anonymous-PII-Dataset contains one million synthetic documents across seventeen languages: English, Vietnamese, Chinese, Japanese, Lao, Tamil, Thai, Burmese,

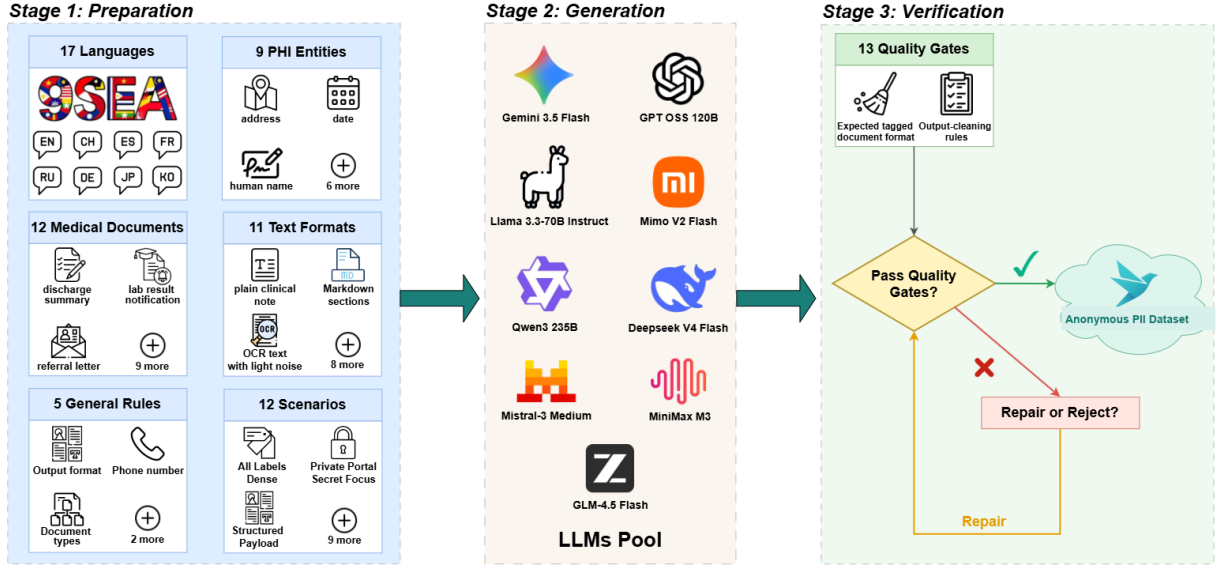


Figure 1: Synthetic data generation and verification pipeline to create **Anonymous-PII-Dataset**.

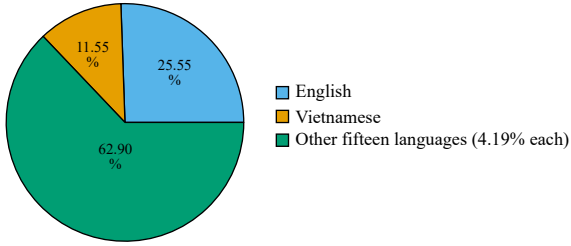


Figure 2: Language distribution of Anonymous-PII-Dataset. The other fifteen languages each contain 41,934 samples (4.19%).

Filipino, Russian, Spanish, Malay, Indonesian, Portuguese, French, Korean, and German. After generating the initial collection, we reviewed its samples and identified opportunities to improve data quality. We then refined the generation process and created a second collection of higher-quality samples. The final dataset mixes selected samples from both collections to reach one million documents while preserving the target language distribution and broader coverage. This design is consistent with sample-wise pretraining data mixing research that jointly considers quality and diversity when determining the resulting data distribution (Xi et al., 2025). The language selection emphasizes Southeast Asian languages, several of which have limited representation in existing PII datasets. Because widely spoken international languages are also used across Southeast Asian countries, we extend the dataset with prominent languages beyond the region, yielding coverage

across different scripts, language families, and resource levels. Figure 2 summarizes the language distribution.

**PII labels** We define a nine-label PII ontology informed by the identifiers and distinguishing attributes described in ISO/IEC 29100:2024 (International Organization for Standardization and International Electrotechnical Commission, 2024):

- **address**: street addresses, postal codes, coordinates, and care locations;
- **company\_name**: hospitals, clinics, departments, companies, and other organizations;
- **date**: birth dates, admission and discharge dates, and other specific datetimes linked to a person or encounter;
- **email\_address**: email addresses;
- **human\_name**: patient, clinician, and other person names;
- **id\_number**: medical record numbers, government identifiers, passport and licence numbers, IP addresses, and account numbers;
- **phone\_number**: telephone and fax numbers;
- **private\_url**: access-bearing patient-portal, result, signed, or private-record URLs;

|     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                  |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 224 | • <b>secret:</b> passwords, API keys, authentication or session tokens, cookies, personal identification numbers, and one-time passwords.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                  |
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| 251 | <b>Stage 1: Preparation</b> Each generation prompt combines six attribute groups that control the content and structure of a sample. Medical documents determine the workflow and content, while text formats determine how that content is expressed. General rules maintain annotation consistency, and scenarios control the operational context and difficulty. Together, these groups capture complementary sources of variation in clinical PII data. Randomly combining attribute values produces varied prompts at scale, an approach supported by evidence that attributed prompts improve synthetic-data diversity and downstream performance while reducing query cost (Yu et al., 2023). We refined the final set of options through project discussions to balance realistic clinical and administrative use cases with broad label and structural coverage. Figure 3 shows the prompt template. |                                                                                  |
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| 270 | 1. <b>Languages:</b> Specifies the target language of the generated document.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                  |
| 271 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                  |
|     | 2. <b>PII labels:</b> Nine labels specify the PII categories and required label coverage for each document.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 272<br>273<br>274                                                                |
|     | 3. <b>Medical documents:</b> Represents PII in common clinical and administrative workflows. The twelve documents are discharge summary; outpatient note; lab-result notification; patient portal access log; insurance claim note; referral letter; pharmacy refill request; appointment reminder; telehealth triage note; medical bill or invoice; FHIR-like Patient and Encounter resource; and HL7-style admission or update message.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 275<br>276<br>277<br>278<br>279<br>280<br>281<br>282<br>283<br>284               |
|     | 4. <b>Text formats:</b> Captures how equivalent information changes across prose, structured records, logs, transcripts, and noisy text. The eleven formats are plain clinical note; Markdown sections; messy nurse or administrative note; table-like rows; JSON-like object; FHIR-like JSON; HL7-like pipe-delimited text; patient portal audit log; voice-scribe transcript; lightly degraded OCR text; and clinical dialogue transcript.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 285<br>286<br>287<br>288<br>289<br>290<br>291<br>292<br>293<br>294               |
|     | 5. <b>General rules:</b> Maintains consistent generation and annotation across combinations of attributes. The five rule groups govern the output format, phone-number construction, private URLs, secrets, and compatibility between medical documents and text formats.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 295<br>296<br>297<br>298<br>299<br>300                                           |
|     | 6. <b>Scenarios:</b> Places PII within realistic operational contexts while controlling label density and difficulty. The twelve scenarios are All Labels Dense; Private Portal Secret Focus; Adversarial Obfuscation; Public Negative Contrast; Structured Payload; General Consumer Admin Support; HR, Employer, School, Insurance, or Telecom Admin; Code, Log, Security, or Account Recovery; Adversarial Formatting; Structured General Payload; One-Hop Deferred Clue; and Public Negative URL and Data Contrast.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 301<br>302<br>303<br>304<br>305<br>306<br>307<br>308<br>309<br>310<br>311<br>312 |

```

user_prompt = f"""
Generate one synthetic {language} {document_type}
in {text_format} format.

Scenario: {scenario_name}
{scenario_description}

Hard constraints:
1. Use at least {min_spans} tagged PII spans.
2. Use at least {min_unique_labels} unique
Anonymous labels.
3. Required labels for this sample: {
required_labels}.
etc.

Required-label coverage before you answer: {"", ".
join(f"{label}=present" for label in
resolved_required_labels) or "none"}.
Minimum coverage before you answer: at least {
min_spans} bracketed tags and at least {
min_unique_labels} unique labels.

Remember: label syntax must be `[value]<label>`
and labels must be one of: {"", ".join(f"<{label}>"
for label in PII_LABELS)}."""

```

**Fig. 3.** User-prompt template for Anonymous-PII-Dataset generation. Braced fields are populated from the sampled generation attributes and validation requirements.

**Hard constraints** The hard-constraint block converts the sampled attributes into explicit generation requirements. It specifies the minimum number of tagged spans and unique labels, lists labels that must appear, and controls when private URLs, secrets, negative examples, and adversarial perturbations are required. It also enforces the exact `[value]<label>` syntax, complete entity boundaries, document-only output, and a final coverage self-check. These constraints guide the model toward drafts that can be checked by the deterministic gates in Stage 3, although a draft is accepted only after passing verification.

**Stage 2: Generation** The generation pool contains nine large language models (LLMs) from different model families. These are Gemini 3.5 Flash (Google DeepMind, 2026), GLM-4.5-Flash (Zeng et al., 2025), Llama 3.3 70B Instruct (Meta AI, 2024), MiMo-V2-Flash (Xiao et al., 2026), Mistral Medium 3 (Mistral AI, 2025), gpt-oss-120b (Agarwal et al., 2025), DeepSeek-V4-Flash (DeepSeek-AI, 2026), Qwen3-235B-A22B (Yang et al., 2025), and MiniMax M3 (MiniMax, 2026). For each sample, the framework sends the assembled prompt to one selected LLM from this pool. Distributing generation across model families reduces the pipeline’s dependence on the behavior of a single generator.

**Stage 3: Verification** Each generated draft enters deterministic verification. Verification uses regular expressions, a deterministic character-level parser, rule-based checks, and SHA-256 hashing. Regular expressions check annotation syntax and language-specific Unicode ranges. The parser reconstructs the raw document and verifies span offsets, while rule-based checks validate phone numbers. SHA-256 hashes detect duplicate documents. Together, thirteen gates check label coverage, span count, document length, offsets, phone-number structure, native-script presence, and duplication. Drafts that pass are accepted, while failed drafts enter the repair workflow. API failures and empty content are rejected because they contain no recoverable document, while unknown scenarios are rejected because the metadata needed to interpret and validate the document is unavailable. For the remaining drafts, conservative regex repair fixes only explicit labels with unambiguous value boundaries, such as misplaced brackets, spacing around tags, or unwrapped structured-field values. Repaired drafts are then revalidated and accepted only if they pass every gate and are unique. Drafts with missing or unknown labels, too few spans, invalid lengths or offsets, templated phone numbers, or missing native script are rejected because correcting them would require inventing content, labels.

## 4 Evaluation

### 4.1 Evaluation Settings

**Evaluation Protocol** We compare Anonymous-PII-Model with four publicly available PII extraction systems: OpenAI Privacy Filter (OpenAI, 2026), GLiNER2 (Zaratiana et al., 2025), SuperClinical-Large-434M-v1 (Science, 2026), and LFM2.5-Encoder-350M-PII-Detector (Liquid AI, 2026). The external evaluation includes twelve language subsets from OpenPII 1.5M (Ai4Privacy, 2026), together with CredData (Yun et al., 2021), Gretel PII Masking (AI, 2024), and Nemotron-PII (Steier et al., 2025). We additionally evaluate every system on the Anonymous-PII Benchmark. Labels produced by each system are mapped to the shared PII ontology before scoring. We report exact-match entity-level micro-F1 by pooling entity counts across documents. A predicted entity is a true positive only when both its PII label and character boundaries exactly match a reference entity. Predictions with an incorrect label or bound-

ary are counted as false positives, while unmatched reference entities are counted as false negatives. Using the pooled counts, the metric is computed as

$$P = \frac{TP}{TP + FP}, \quad R = \frac{TP}{TP + FN}, \quad (1)$$

$$F_1 = \frac{2PR}{P + R} = \frac{2TP}{2TP + FP + FN}.$$

**Model Development** Our initial model development treated PII extraction as autoregressive structured generation. We first applied supervised fine-tuning (SFT) and subsequently reinforcement learning (RL), but sequential decoding made inference slow and the resulting extraction quality was not competitive. We therefore adopted the one-pass token-classification approach used by OpenAI Privacy Filter (OpenAI, 2026). This approach classifies each token using bidirectional document context instead of generating entities token by token. BIOES marks tokens as Beginning, Inside, End, Single-token, or Outside (O) relative to an entity. Anonymous-PII-Model fine-tunes LFM2.5-350M with a classifier containing 37 output classes: O and four states for each of the nine PII labels. A linear classification head predicts a BIOES state for each token. Constrained Viterbi decoding then converts the predicted sequence into character-level entity spans while enforcing valid BIOES transitions (Lester et al., 2020).

## 4.2 Results

**Overall comparison** Table 1 reports exact-match entity-level micro-F1 for the evaluated systems. Anonymous-PII-Model ranks first on every benchmark shown. Across the fifteen external benchmarks, it achieves an unweighted mean F1 of 0.827, exceeding OpenAI Privacy Filter, the strongest baseline by external mean, by 0.169. When the Anonymous-PII Benchmark is included, the overall means are 0.833 and 0.644, respectively. The consistent advantage across both external and in-domain evaluations suggests that the improvement is not confined to the distribution used to develop Anonymous-PII-Model.

**Multilingual performance** On the twelve OpenPII 1.5M language benchmarks, Anonymous-PII-Model scores between 0.739 and 0.880 and ranks first in every language. Its largest margins over the strongest competing score occur for Vietnamese (0.880 versus 0.634),

Chinese (0.816 versus 0.572), and Korean (0.739 versus 0.554). This pattern indicates that the external mean is not driven only by English and that the model transfers effectively across several languages and scripts. However, the lower absolute scores for Korean and Japanese show that multilingual performance is not uniform, leaving room for language-specific analysis and improvement.

**Cross-dataset performance** Anonymous-PII-Model achieves F1 scores of 0.590 on CredData, 0.872 on Gretel, and 0.956 on Nemotron. The strongest baseline scores on the same benchmarks are 0.370, 0.729, and 0.878, giving margins of 0.220, 0.143, and 0.078, respectively. Positive margins across all three datasets provide evidence of transfer beyond a single annotation source. CredData remains substantially more difficult for every system, indicating that differences in domain, document structure, or annotation policy still present a meaningful challenge.

**Anonymous-PII Benchmark** The Anonymous-PII Benchmark combines standard examples with examples emphasizing adversarial surface forms. On this benchmark, Anonymous-PII-Model achieves an F1 of 0.878, compared with 0.540 for the strongest baseline. The 0.338 margin shows that the model handles the ontology and perturbations represented in its target setting more effectively than the compared systems. Because this is an in-domain evaluation, we report and interpret it separately from the external mean rather than treating it as direct evidence of generalization.

Taken together, the results show consistent gains across languages and datasets, while the lower scores on CredData, Korean, and Japanese identify important directions for further evaluation.

**Data and code availability** For double-blind review, the code and paper artifacts are available through the anonymized repository at <https://anonymous.4open.science/r/meddies-pii-anonymous-3775/README.md>. The dataset described here is synthetic and was not constructed from real patient records. For an anonymous release, identifying information must also be removed from examples, filenames, meta-data, logs, and linked artifacts. Upon acceptance, we will publicly release Anonymous-PII-Dataset,

Table 1: Exact-match entity-level micro-F1 scores. The best result for each benchmark is shown in bold.

| Benchmark                      | Anonymous PII Model | OpenAI Privacy Filter | GLiNER2 | SuperClinical Large 434M | LFM2.5 Encoder 350M PII Detector |
|--------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|---------|--------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <i>External evaluation</i>     |                     |                       |         |                          |                                  |
| OpenPII 1.5M (de)              | <b>0.827</b>        | 0.716                 | 0.663   | 0.620                    | 0.610                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (en)              | <b>0.878</b>        | 0.745                 | 0.687   | 0.656                    | 0.568                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (es)              | <b>0.870</b>        | 0.794                 | 0.732   | 0.683                    | 0.655                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (fil)             | <b>0.848</b>        | 0.667                 | 0.690   | 0.584                    | 0.600                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (fr)              | <b>0.844</b>        | 0.738                 | 0.674   | 0.604                    | 0.611                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (id)              | <b>0.848</b>        | 0.664                 | 0.688   | 0.566                    | 0.627                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (ja)              | <b>0.750</b>        | 0.549                 | 0.366   | 0.493                    | 0.479                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (ko)              | <b>0.739</b>        | 0.554                 | 0.322   | 0.545                    | 0.460                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (ms)              | <b>0.839</b>        | 0.640                 | 0.692   | 0.547                    | 0.587                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (pt)              | <b>0.855</b>        | 0.756                 | 0.692   | 0.687                    | 0.651                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (vi)              | <b>0.880</b>        | 0.634                 | 0.628   | 0.499                    | 0.615                            |
| OpenPII 1.5M (zh)              | <b>0.816</b>        | 0.572                 | 0.453   | 0.428                    | 0.548                            |
| CredData (en)                  | <b>0.590</b>        | 0.370                 | 0.357   | 0.150                    | 0.263                            |
| Gretel (en)                    | <b>0.872</b>        | 0.697                 | 0.588   | 0.715                    | 0.729                            |
| Nemotron (en)                  | <b>0.956</b>        | 0.778                 | 0.692   | 0.878                    | 0.574                            |
| <b>External mean</b>           | <b>0.827</b>        | 0.658                 | 0.595   | 0.577                    | 0.572                            |
| <b>Anonymous-PII Benchmark</b> | <b>0.878</b>        | 0.540                 | 0.476   | 0.244                    | 0.269                            |
| <b>Overall mean</b>            | <b>0.833</b>        | 0.644                 | 0.581   | 0.538                    | 0.536                            |

the Anonymous-PII Benchmark, Anonymous-PII-Model, the generation framework, and the evaluation code.

## 5 Limitations

Anonymous-PII-Dataset is entirely synthetic and may not capture all linguistic variation, documentation practices, and annotation ambiguity found in real-world clinical records. Its deterministic gates enforce the declared structural and annotation requirements, but they do not directly measure the semantic naturalness of every generated document. In addition, the present evaluation focuses on synthetic PII benchmarks and Anonymous-PII Benchmark data; evaluation on appropriately governed real clinical records remains an important direction for future work.

## 6 Conclusion

We presented **Anonymous-PII-Dataset**, a synthetic clinical PII dataset containing one million documents across seventeen languages and nine PII labels. After reviewing the initial generation, we refined the process, generated a second collection of higher-quality samples, and mixed both collections to preserve the target distribution and broader coverage. The improved process controls multiple document and scenario attributes and selects one generator per sample from a pool of nine models. Thirteen deterministic gates then validate

each sample before acceptance. **Anonymous-PII-Model** achieves the highest performance among the evaluated systems across all reported external benchmarks and the **Anonymous-PII Benchmark**, demonstrating the downstream utility of the generated data. By making the dataset, benchmark, model, generation framework, and evaluation code publicly available upon acceptance, we aim to support further research on multilingual clinical de-identification and synthetic PII generation.

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